

THE CAPITAL ADVANTAGE

Repeat founders are attracting sizeable institutional capital at the very start of their new ventures

Temple'

\$54
Million

(Friends and family round, 2026)

AllHome
One-stop shop for your home

\$40
Million (approx)

(across equity and debt in multiple rounds)

NURIX

\$42
Million

(Across three rounds)

OffBeat
studios

₹100
Crore

(Seed funding)



ILLUSTRATION BY **RAJ VERMA/AI**

across the founders and brands he backs. "It's impossible to build another food-delivery platform or another electronics-first marketplace," he says. "Consumers already have dozens of apps competing for attention. Unless a product offers something meaningfully different, persuading them to download one more has become increasingly difficult."

Customer acquisition costs have risen in tandem. "When companies such as boAt and Mamaearth were scaling five-six years ago, relatively few brands were targeting the same customer with similar products," says Bhalerao. "Today, for every category, at least ten brands are competing for the same customer at a similar price point."

The opportunity set has expanded as well. A decade ago, consumer internet attracted most of the capital, talent and entrepreneurial energy. Today, founders can plausibly build venture-scale businesses in enterprise software, manufacturing, industrial technology, deeptech and specialised research. Some of these categories—spacetech, for example—were closed to private capital a decade ago.

That shift in market conditions is only part of the story. Years spent creating, scaling and exiting businesses leave entrepreneurs with capital, conviction and a different appetite for risk. For Kunal Khattar, a serial entrepreneur and founding partner at VC fund Ad-

vantEdge, that shift often begins with ambition.

"They're independently wealthy. They're not doing this for money," says Khattar. "At that point, usually bigger questions, like a new challenge or motivation, take over."

For many second-time founders, difficulty is part of the appeal. Goyal has called the odds of LAT Aerospace succeeding "99.9% impossible." Those odds are precisely what make the problem worth pursuing.

But it is not just about ambition, bravado or restlessness. These founders are acutely self-aware. They know what they bring to the table, and what they don't. They also understand that a company